Student Numbers	**Names**
ST10438801	Yamika Govender
ST10435813	Laiken Diedrick
ST10440113	Diya Nikhita Singh

Section A: Research on Three Existing Budgeting Apps

Budgeting apps are digital tools that help people effectively manage their finances by keeping track of income, expenses, and savings. These budgeting apps let users define financial goals, create tailored budgets, and monitor their spending habits in real time. Budget applications are very beneficial as they help in managing your finances easily by informing you about your cashflow. (Equifax ,2024). Many users such as students, entrepreneurs, and people who find themselves in tough financial situations turn to budget apps for help. (Muzyka. R, 2024). Researching these three apps offered insight as to how budgeting apps work, what design aspects are typically used (e.g: layout), as well as usual features that can be included. The existing budgeting apps which were researched were RocketMoney, YNAB and Spendee. These apps were chosen due to their Android compatibility as well as similar features to the assignment requirements (e.g: manually added transactions, progress charts, and reviewing previous budget entries).

Budgeting App One: RocketMoney

Rocket Companies' budgeting app, Rocket Money, examines your expenses and spending patterns. Despite being a free mobile app, your plan will determine which services you may access. (Hamilton, K, 2022). By using it, you can get help with managing your money, making your bills lower, and even getting rid of subscriptions you don't want so that you can have a better financial life. (Hamilton, K, 2022). Rocket Money functions through users being able to directly attach their bank accounts to the application via Plaid. (Hamilton, K, 2022). Once your accounts are linked, you can have a single view of all your income and expenditure. (NextGen Money Skills, 2024). The app has read-only access to financial accounts, which means that money can't move from one account to another without your approval. (NextGen Money Skills, 2024). Lastly, the app allows for a "pay what you think is fair" that allows you to just pay what feels appropriate for you and your wallet, after a free trial to test it out and is offered in both a free and a premium version. (Hamilton, K, 2022).

Pros

- A free plan is available which offers users access to essential financial management tools. (Hamilton, K, 2022).
- It provides useful budgeting tools that make tracking spending and saving money simple. (NextGen Money Skills, 2024).
- Users will find it easy to use because of the interface's simplicity and cleanliness. (Hamilton, K, 2022).

- You get personalized advice to improve your financial decision making. (In, T. 2025).

- Connect all banks accounts fast - Signing into your banks accounts with Rocket Money only takes a few minutes. Once everything is linked, you simply get a comprehensive report of your money all in one place. (In, T. 2025).

- By linking multiple accounts, the Rocket Money app lets you see all your financial information in a single place. This includes your debt investment savings and checking accounts. (Ashar, K. 2025).

Cons

- It doesn't have the advanced features that big companies would probably want, like being able to track investment accounts. (Connors. T, 2025).

- The free plan comes with limited features, as more advanced budgeting tools are not available without upgrading to Premium. (NextGen Money Skills, 2024).

- There's very little customer support available, as it does not always meet user expectations. (Connors. T, 2025).

- Not all services are provided for free. Premium features like bill negotiating, net worth, savings goals, and customized budget categories require a monthly subscription. It will take longer to correctly categorize your purchases and adhere to your desired budget without these features. (Más Colombia. 2023).

- The software can occasionally be slow, according to some users, which takes away from the overall user experience. (Más Colombia. 2023).

- Although Rocket Money's bill negotiating tool works with third-party suppliers that the app monitors, there is a small risk when you give your bill payments to outside parties. (Matthews, C. 2024).

Innovative Features

- Safe to Spend gives you a clear indication of how much money you actually have left over after bills and budgets, not simply your bank account balance. (Conger. C, 2026).

- The program retrieves transactions from all of your linked accounts and automatically classifies expenditure (grocery, bills, entertainment, etc.) without requiring you to add anything. (Conger. C, 2026).

- To make it simple for you to understand what you're paying for each month, Rocket Money automatically scans your recurring subscriptions. (Conger. C, 2026).

<u>Budgeting App Two: Spendee</u>

According to Spendee(2026), Spendee is a budgeting app, supported on Android and iOS, which helps users monitor their income and expenses, while helping them see their monthly cash flow in a simple and effective manner as well as allowing users to understand their spending habits better.Spendee(2026) mentioned that, the target users for Spendee refers to adults, specifically working professionals, who need to gain more control over their finances. Spendee(2026) also mentioned that these users typically utilise this app to help them pay off their debts, save up for a future goal or properly track their expenses.

Pros

-It gives you the option to manually input your transactions/expenses if you do not want to link your bank account to the app. (Spendee,2026)

-The UI design and layout have a professional appearance. (Spendee,2026)

-The navigation is beginner-friendly. (Spendee,2026)

-When you are creating a transaction, you have an option to add a receipt/photo. (Spendee,2026)

-The app gives the user alerts or notifications if they're about to exceed their budget. Sabatier(2024)

-The app notifies the user of upcoming bill payment deadlines. Sabatier(2024)

- Spendee has a 'Shared Wallet' feature, which allows more than one person access to a wallet(transaction/expense container) so that multiple people can manage the expenses there. Spendee(2026)

- Users have access to articles on the app which would further educate them on reaching financial stability as well as good spending habits. Spendee(2026)

Cons

- Customer service is very poor and performance isn't good in regard to syncing with bank accounts due to the process being slow, TrustPilot(2026)

- Spendee is not able to sync to all banks, only certain ones, Sabatier(2024)

- A premium subscription will be to be obtained in order to add more than one a budget and access the use of a crypto wallet, Spendee(2026)

Innovative features

-The app asks you series of questions when you use it for the first time in order to personalize the experience more for the user.(Spendee,2026)

-The user is able to search for transactions through categories, people, labels or expense descriptions.(Spendee,2026)

-The app has an AI scanner which instantly collects data from any receipt photos that you scan, rather than you having to enter the information manually. (Spendee,2026)

-Spendee has 4 different ways of keeping track of cashflow through different wallets (transaction containers). Cash Wallet is for transactions you manually handle yourself; Bank Wallet is if you want to link to a bank account and have the transactions entered automatically from the bank account, E-Wallet is for services such as PayPal and Crypto Wallet is for managing crypto transactions. (Spendee,2026)

Budgeting App Three: You Need A Budget (YNAB)

YNAB is a personal budgeting app that helps users maintain their finances using zero-based budgeting.This is where money is given a specific purpose such as expenses, savings or debt payments (Luthi, 2022). The app is designed to aid its users in having better control over their spending by helping them organise their income into categories and to track their expenses in real time. The users can create categories, watch their spending habits and review their progress financially with reports and charts (Luthi, 2022). The application supports Android, iOS and web platforms that allows users to access and update their budgets from multiple devices (Luthi, 2022).

Pros

- Use a structured budgeting approach which helps encourage its users to plan their spending before they make any purchases rather than just tracking their expenses (May, 2026).
- They have customisable categories that allows the users to create categories that suit their personal financial situation (Luthi, 2022).
- Provides financial reports in detail which includes their spending reports, tracking their net worth and income vs. expense analysis to help users understand their habits financially (Luthi, 2022).
- Offers educational resources like tutorials and workshops to help users learn how to manage their finances and skills (May, 2026).
- YNAB allows users to assign money to their specific goals to help them more effectively manage their finances (May, 2026)
- YNAB makes sure users review their budgets to raise better awareness to keep up with their priorities by adjusting their spending (Luthi, 2022)

Cons

- It is a paid subscription costing around R260,00 per month or R2200,00 per year (Adam and Adam, 2018).

- The system has a more complex learning curve compared to other budgeting apps especially for users that are unfamiliar with zero-based budgeting (Adam and Adam, 2018).

- The application requires active/ consistent participation from its users like regular entries on transactions and budget adjustments

Innovative Features

- "Give every dollar a job" feature where users must give their income to a specific category before spending it (Luthi, 2022).

- Their goal-based budgeting that allows their users to plan for and save for future expenses by defining financial goals and tracking their progress over time (Luthi, 2022).

- Gives real-time tracking and spending reports to help users understand their situation and make better decisions (Luthi, 2022).

- These features help users improve financial habits and have better control over their money (Luthi, 2022).

<u>List of Best Features to be included in BudgetBee</u>

RocketMoney

- Real-time notifications – the app sends alerts for overdrafts or usual charges
- Spending limits – set an amount that you would want to spend per category and get alerted before you go over

Spendee

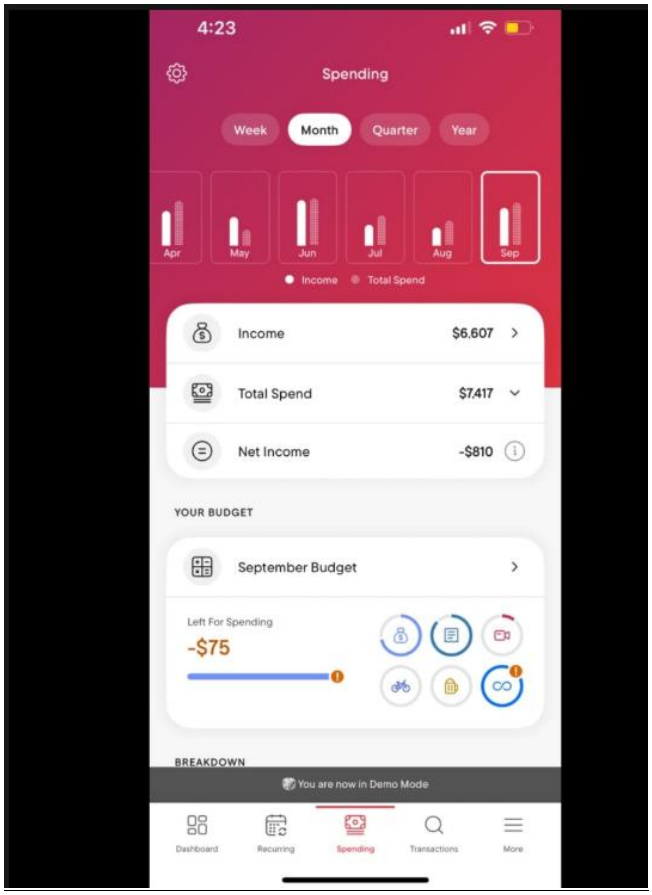
- Option to manually input transactions
- Has a section where user can view different articles based on better spending, financial advice,etc

YNAB

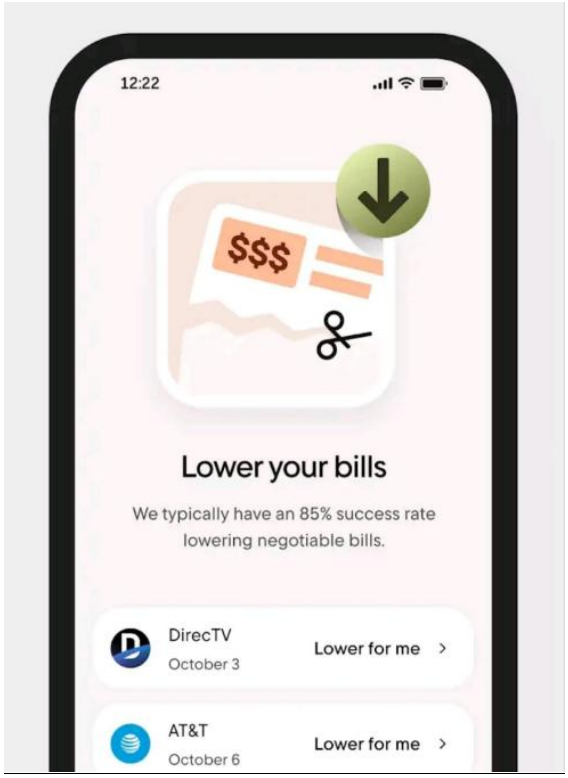
- Categories - Users are able to select a category to add their expenses
- Budget tracking - users can track their spending to compare what they have spent compared to their planned budget
- Spending reports - users can view a summary report of their spending

With these apps, you get to plan your finances, arrange your spending habits unconsciously, know your spending in real time, and have all your financial data in one place. (Kalinin. K, 2024). Budget applications present all of your accounts, credit cards, loans, and investments on a single screen which helps you in getting a comprehensive view of your finances, which provides a clear view that enables you to keep track of your expenses, find areas that can be saved, and make quick financial decisions. (Kalinin. K, 2024). Users can learn more about how they spend their money and make informed financial decisions by utilizing a budgeting app on a regular basis as users get improved financial knowledge and better budgeting techniques. (Paige, 2024).

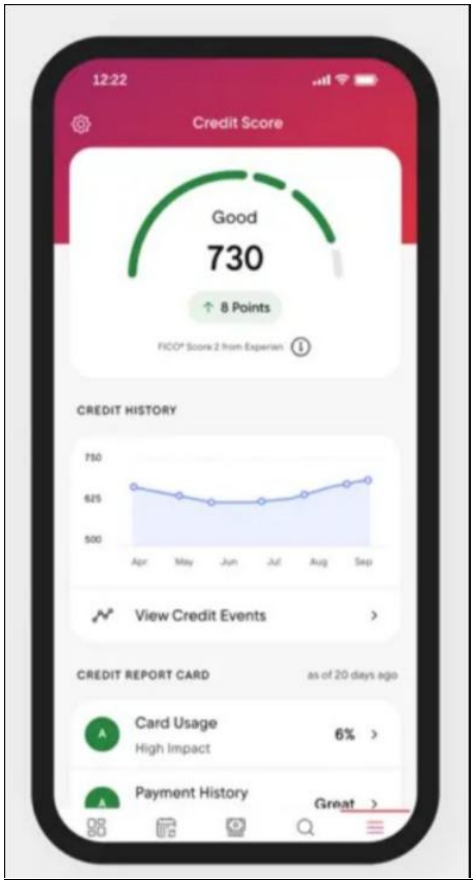
<u>Screenshots of Rocket Money:</u>



- The tab above shows a graph that shows the user their income and their total expenditure for the month, and a card with the exact amounts that the user spent and received as their income.

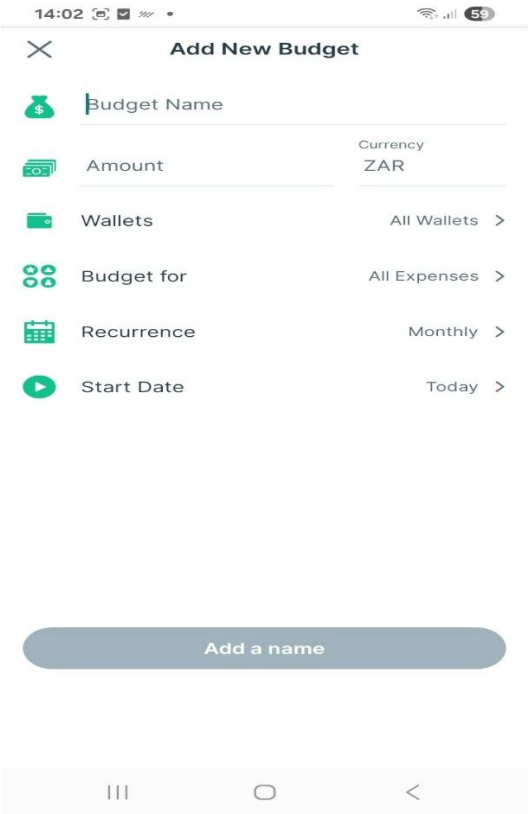


- This tab shows how Rocket Money helps to lower existing bills by negotiation

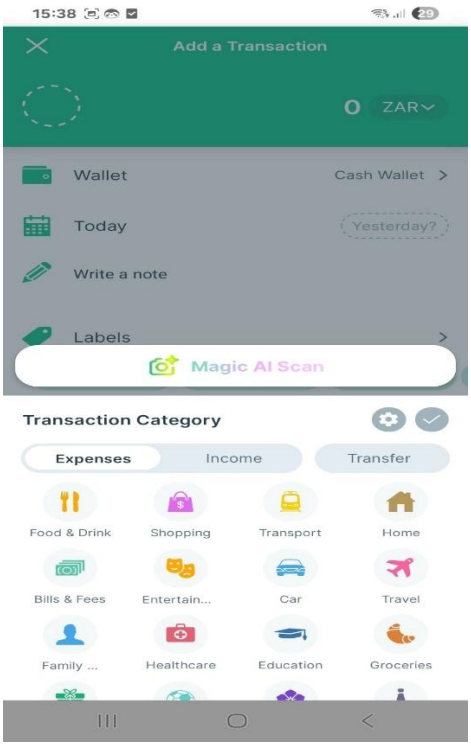


- This tab allows the user to monitor events that affect their credit score

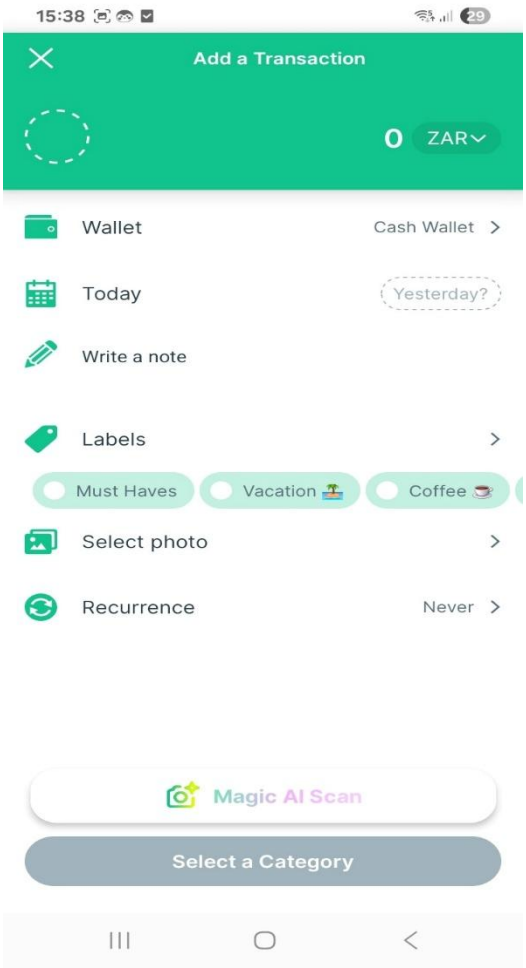
Spendee Screenshots



- This is the section where the user will be able to create a new budget.

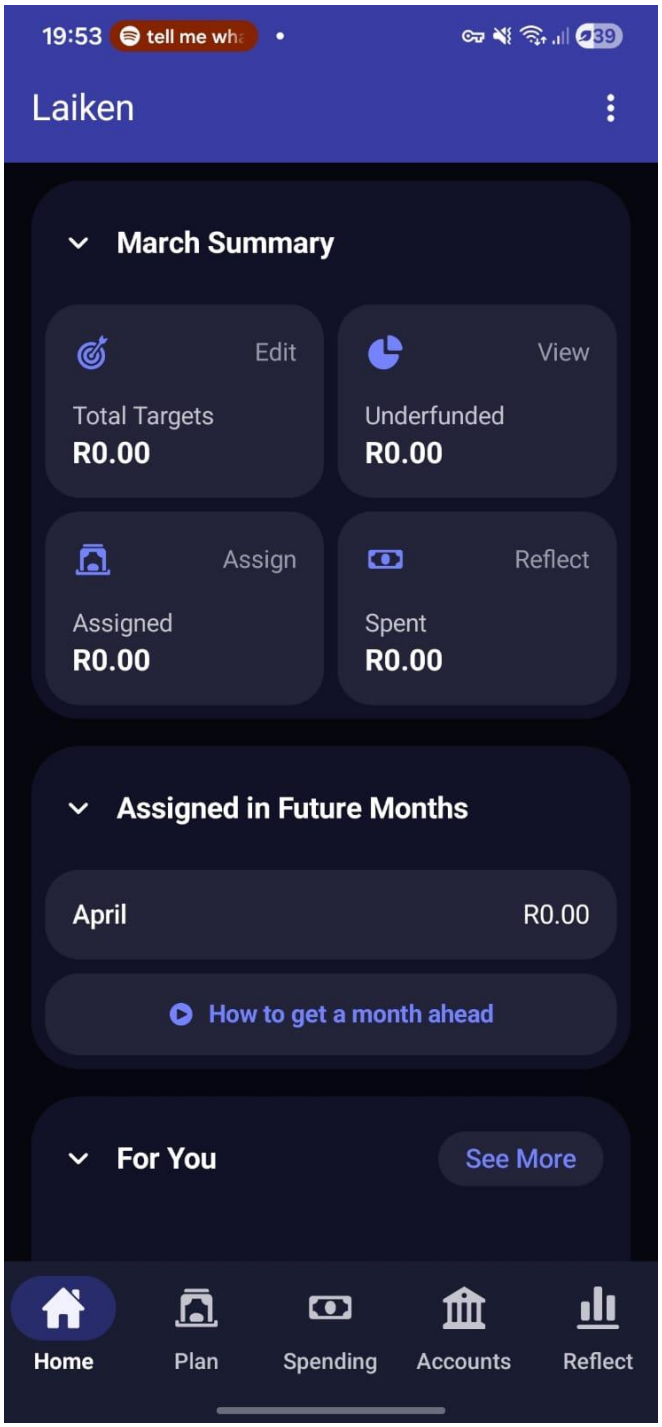


- This is how the user will add a category when adding a new transaction for expenses. The same will apply for income and transfers.

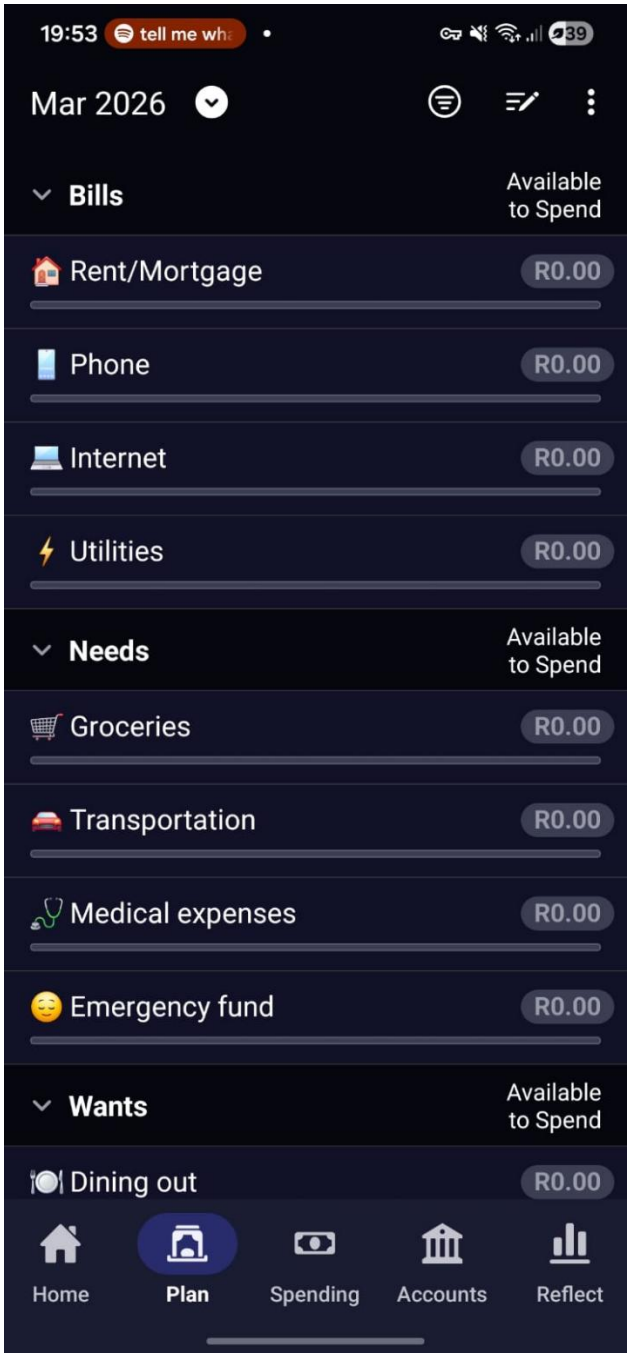


- This is the section in which the user will create a new transaction

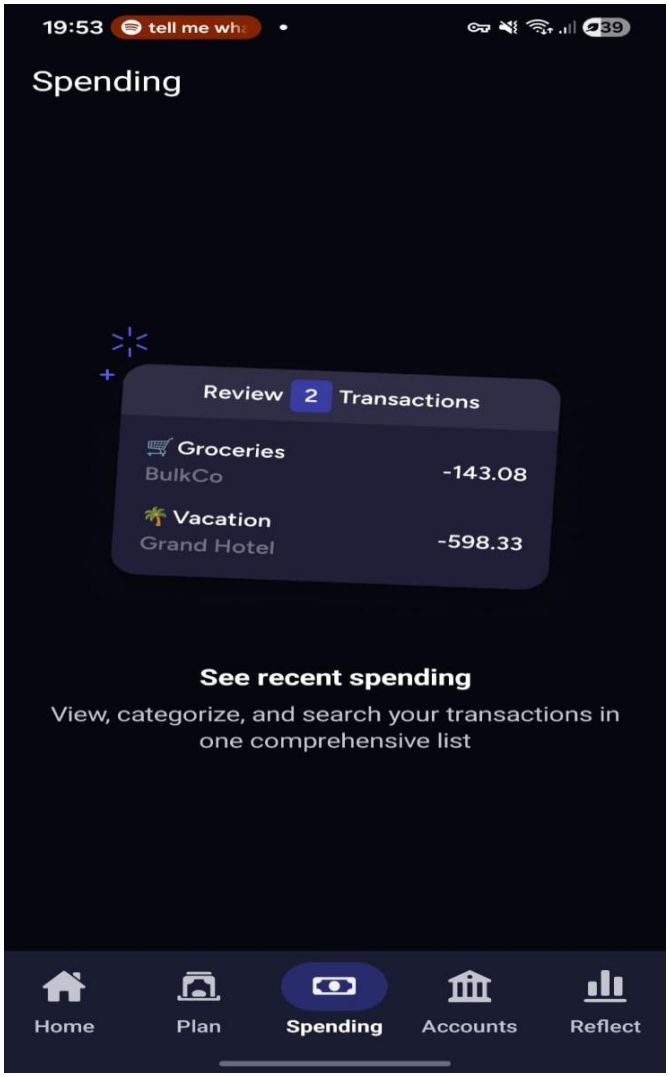
YNAB Screenshots:



- This image is the home dashboard where it shows the summary for various categories for the month as well as planning for the month after



- This page shows how much money you have to plan to spend on specific categories



- This page you can view the money you have spent in one summary aswell as search for them

SECTION B - BudgetBee essay

Our application Budget Bee is a budgeting application which is designed to help users track their expenses and manage their income more effectively. Our application has gamification elements to help motivate users to use the app consistently and improve their financial habits. We have combined financial tracking with other interactive features to make Budget Bee more engaging to help users improve their management of financial skills.

When the user opens the app, they will view the Budgetbee logo with a light orange background. The user will first see 2 tabs, one for registration and one for login. The registration tab will have a light orange background with a small image of a bee by the top right corner of the screen. The user will also have to add a profile pic for account registration. The layout of the login page will also include a light orange background and an image of the logo above the Login heading. There will be a GIF that will be used to welcome the user to the app.

The layout of the home page of the app includes a white background, along with each tab that can be accessed with black and yellow buttons, such as the statement section, progress dashboard, expense entry and category amounts. In the right-hand corner of the screen, there will be a small section which will display the profile picture that the user selected, with their username next to the profile picture and a notification icon. Each tab of the app will include a navbar on the top, with white text if the navbar is black and black text if the navbar is white, with an arrow by the heading, to navigate back to the home tab. Lastly, the buttons for downloading statements from the month, optionally uploading receipts and adding a budget entry will be in yellow, with black text, indicating what the buttons do.

The font used for the heading is cherry bomb and in bold for and in black and the text in the buttons use Londrina solid, for the home page. The tab will also include a search feature on the top of the screen, which will include a search button and filter button. The buttons will be in black with the search and filter icon being in white. The buttons will be part of a yellow bar for the user to enter their input for the search.

The category Amounts Tab starts off with a yellow card, showing the total amount spent by the user and the top category in which money was spent, in black text. The categories that the user spent money on is displayed in a list after, with the names of the categories and the icons before the names.

The expense entry tab includes a yellow card on the top, displaying the total amount in a brown text. The user then has the option to select a transaction date, a category from a list of options, and a text field to add a description. When an option is selected from the categories list, the option will be selected in yellow.

The statements tab will include a card to show the time period from the beginning of the month to the end of the month. There will be a list of statements below the card, to download monthly statements from the month, with a yellow download button. On the bottom, there is a yellow button that the user can upload files with, if they wish to do so.

The progression bar will be in the rewards tab, showing the level of xp earned being displayed in yellow, and the level that the user is displayed in bold, on the top right-hand corner of the card.

The tab will also let users claim points for completing objectives from the month. The tab will have a white background and display progression cards, to show the level of xp earned for each objective. There will be an additional card in black, that will display the total credit score that the user has achieved, with yellow text within the card.

The budget entry tab includes a list of previous budget entries that were made by the user, in yellow cards with icons before the name of the entry names. The amount is also displayed on the card, in black text. Lastly, A yellow button is added below the cards, to add a budget entry, for the month.

<u>Detailed list of requirements:</u>

1. User Registration and Login

The registration tab is the section where a user can create a new account into the game for the first time, where they can set a username and password. The user will have to enter their first name, last name, email address, a custom username and a password. Our application log in securely to access the system with the accounts that they created after registering.

Functional Requirements:

- Users will register for a new account using their: Name, surname, email, username and password.
- The system will automatically generate a unique Gamer ID for each user
- During registration users will choose a profile picture from a setlist of bee-themed images provided by our application and users cannot upload their own images
- Once registration is completed all data will be saved in a local db.
- Users will log into the app with their game ID and password
- If login credentials are correct, they will be redirected to the application's main dashboard
- If the login credentials are incorrect the system will display an error message and prompt the user to try again.

Monthly Budget Target

The application must allow users to set a monthly budget goal to track their spending

Functional Requirements:

- Users will set a budget target for each month
- The system will store that budget and compare it with the expenses the user records

- The system will calculate total monthly expenses, remaining budget amount and budget percentage usage
- The system will display all information on the dashboard with a progress bar showing their budget usage
- If the user does exceed their budget the system will display a visual alert
- The system will send a monthly reminder to prompt the users to set a new budget monthly

Expenses

The application will allow users to record their spending daily expenses

Functional Requirements:

- The user will be able to add a new expense including expense amount, date of transaction, description, category and optionally add an attachment
- The user must select a category: groceries, transport, entertainment, utilities or other
- Each expense will be saved to the local db and linked to the user
- The application will update the users progress on their budget automatically when a new expense is added

Expense Category

The system will allow its users to sort their expenses in categories and allow the user to view all used categories; to see how much money was spent on each category.

Functional Requirements

- The users to select a category when adding their expenses
- The system will store the category information with each expense entry
- The system will provide a Category amount section to view the total amount spent per category

Attachment Upload

This will be where users may attach a document/ photo when recording expenses.

Functional Requirements:

- When a new expense is entered the user will have the option to upload a receipt image/ photo
- It will be linked to the corresponding expense entry

- The user will be able to view and download the attachment from their expense history
- The feature is optional and expenses can be saved without them

Expense Search

The system will allow users to search through existing expenses and filter the expenses, which will display the details of budget entries added with the date and time, description and the category of the entry.

Functional Requirements:

- The user will be able to search expenses using a search bar
- Expenses will be filtered weekly, monthly or a custom date selection
- Results will be shown in a table format by date, description, category and amount

Statements

The application will allow users to generate and download financial statements, from the month of their expenses and income

Functional Requirements:

Users will be able to download statements based on their selected date range which would include expense records, dates, categories, descriptions and their total spending for that period

Gamification and rewards

Budget Bee will incorporate gamification to make budgeting more fun to engage users

Functional Requirements:

- Users will earn XP points (experience points) when they complete their financial objectives like staying within budget, consistent expenses records, reaching their saving goals
- The system will track the users XP which accumulates over time and display it in their profile or rewards section
- Reward points will be given to users for achieving smaller goals, contributing to their in-app credit score
- The application will display a progression bar with different levels to show how the user advances within the reward system
- Users will get access to the rewards section when milestones are complete

Savings

The application will allow users to set saving goals and track them

Functional Requirements

- The user will be able to set a target amount to save
- The system will display a progress bar to show their progress
- The progress bar will increase when the user stays under budget and accumulates savings

Notifications

The application will send reminders for consistent financial tracking

Functional requirements:

- The system will send daily reminders prompting users to record expenses and income
- The system will send a monthly reminder prompting users to set a new budget
- Notifications appear within the application

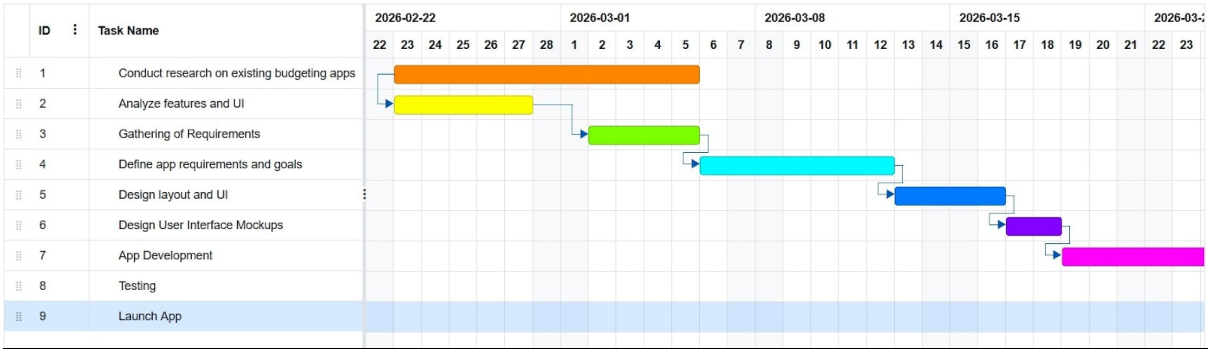
Data Storage

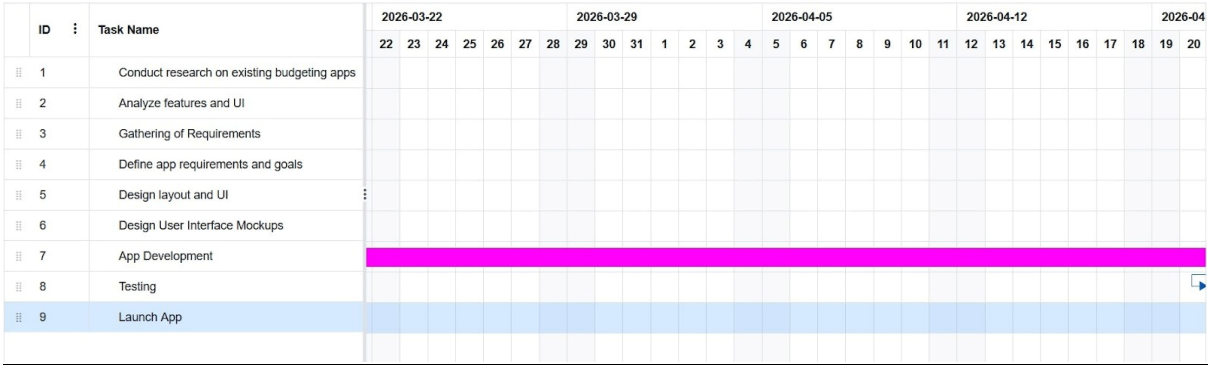
All the data from the application will be stored in a local database

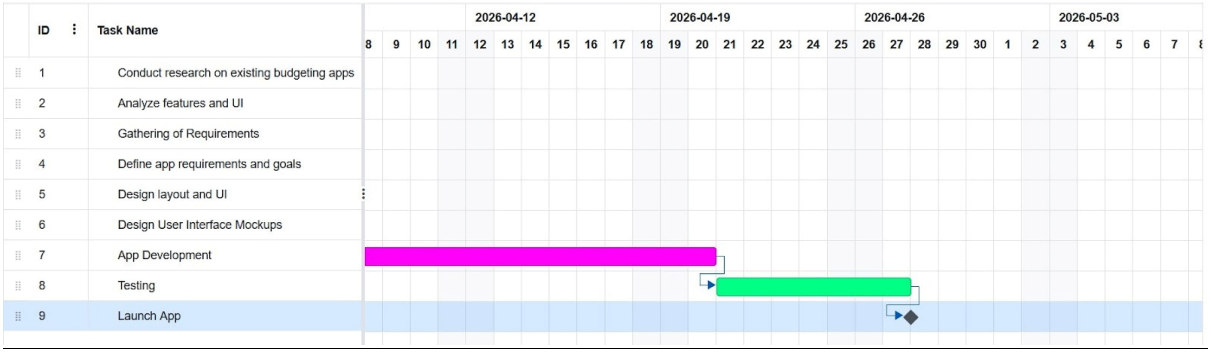
It will store users account details, expense entries, categories, budget targets, rewards and xp points and receipt file paths to ensure that the user's information and financial records are stored safely and can be retrieved when it is needed

In conclusion, BudgetBee will be an engaging, user-friendly app to help users track and manage their spending habits as well as their cash flow, while using gamification features to make budgeting a fun experience and set it apart from the typical existing budget apps. Through the research and planning conducted throughout the reports, BudgetBee's requirements and features have been defined, the layout and navigation have been planned out as well as the technology needed for development, all that remains is to bring the app to life to fulfil its purpose of managing personal finances and keeping track of spending habits in order to keep its users in good financial stability.

Project Plan(Gantt Chart)

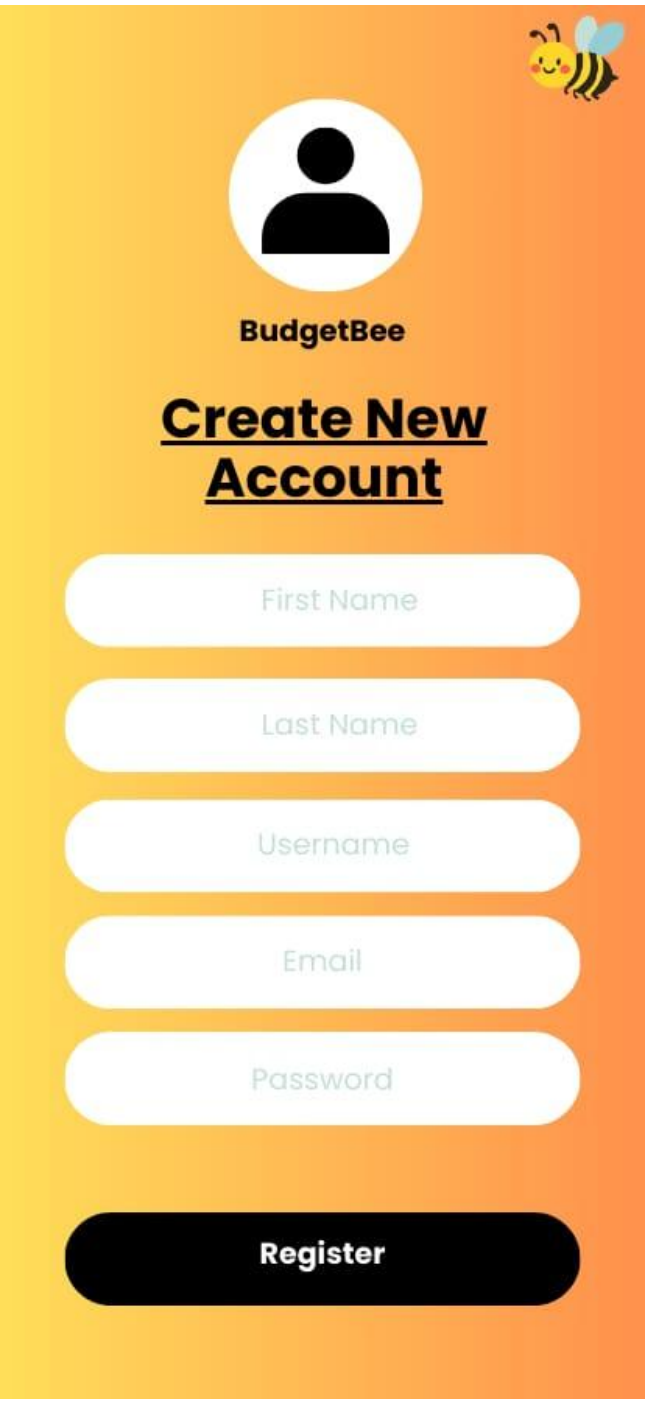




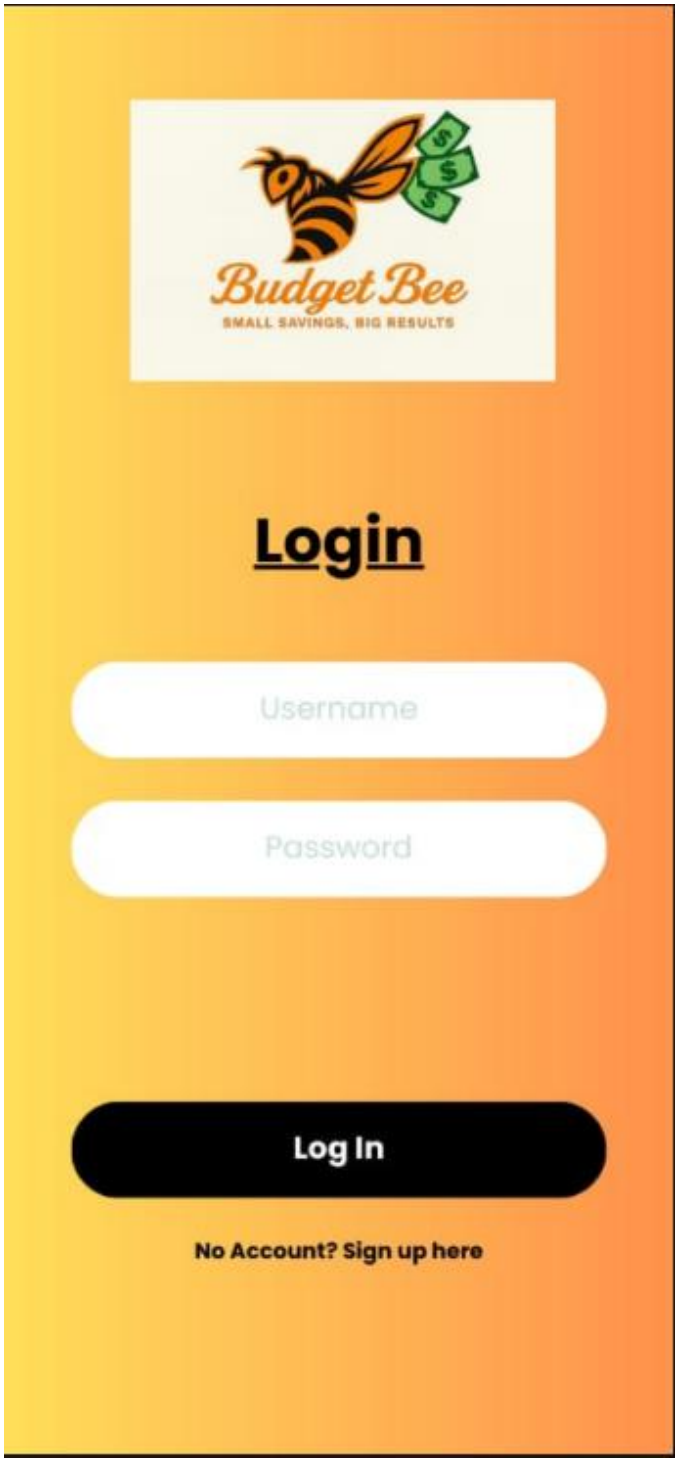


BudgetBee logo:

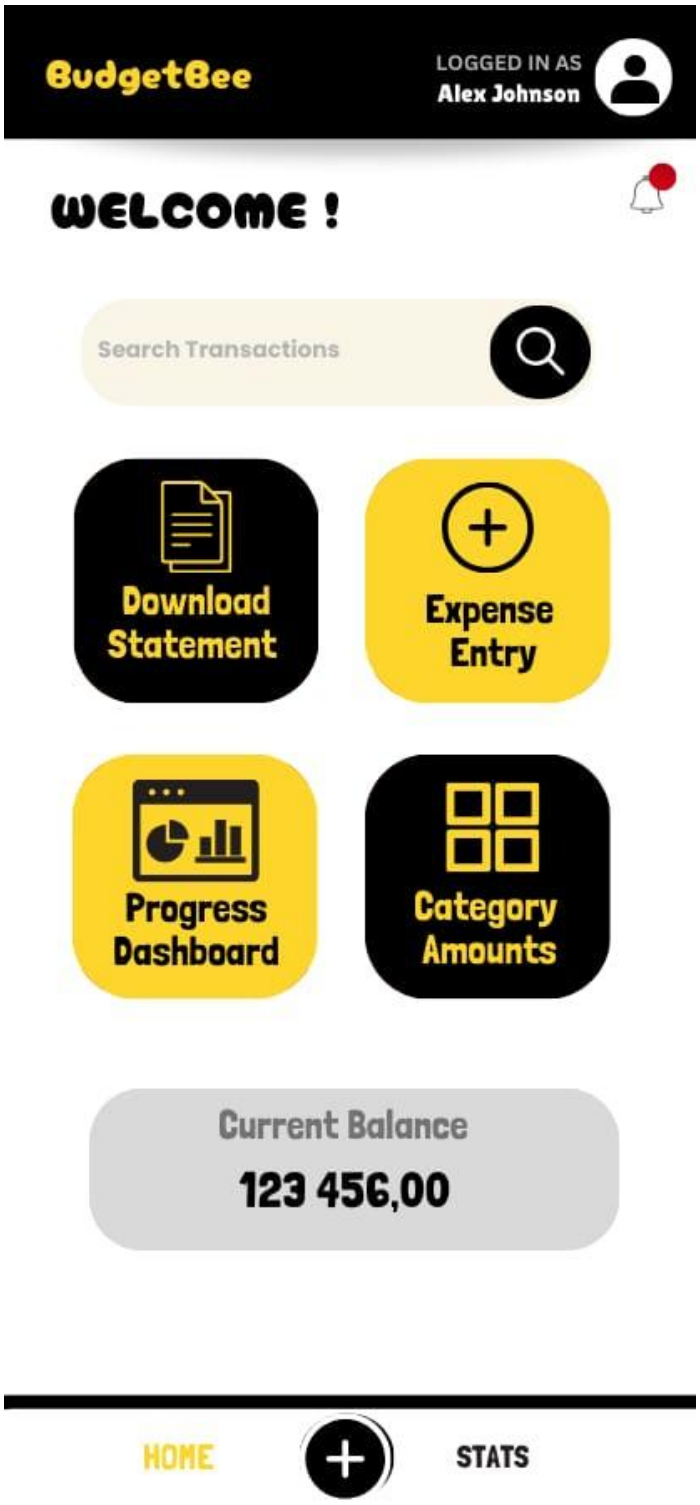
Mock-up of the layouts:



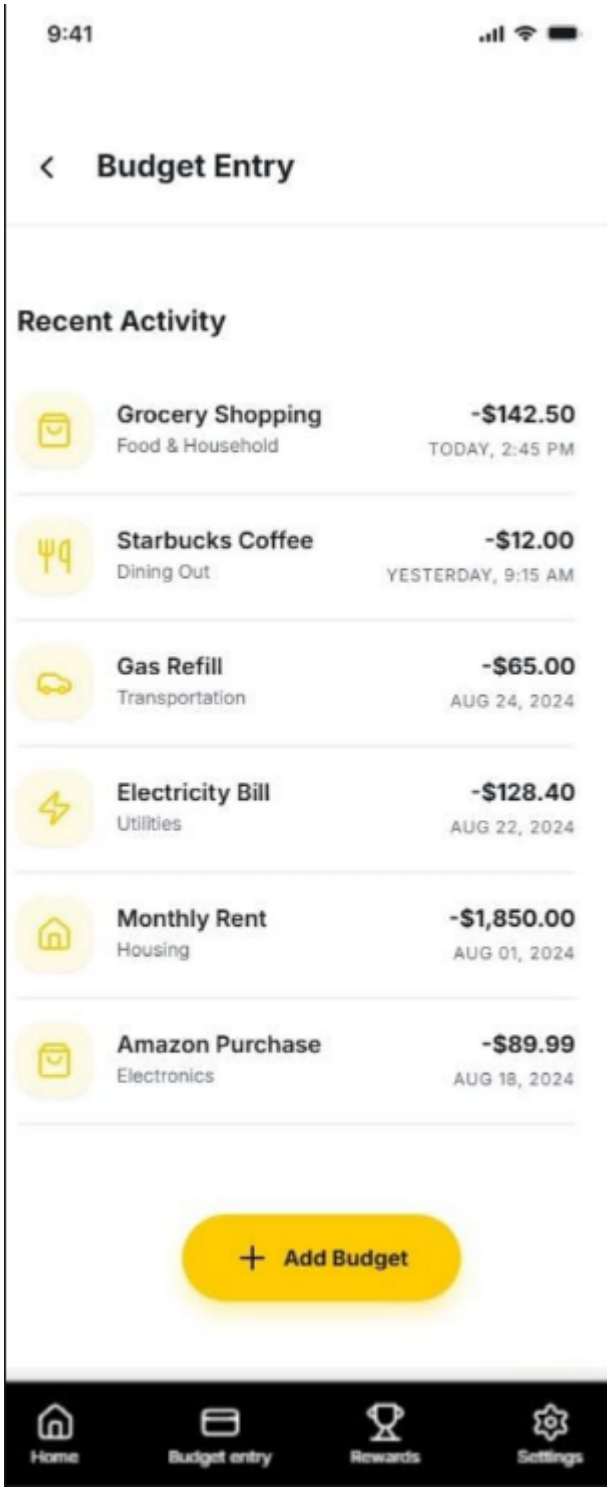
Registration


Budget Bee
SMALL SAVINGS, BIG RESULTS
Login
Username
Password
Log In
No Account? Sign up here

Login Tab

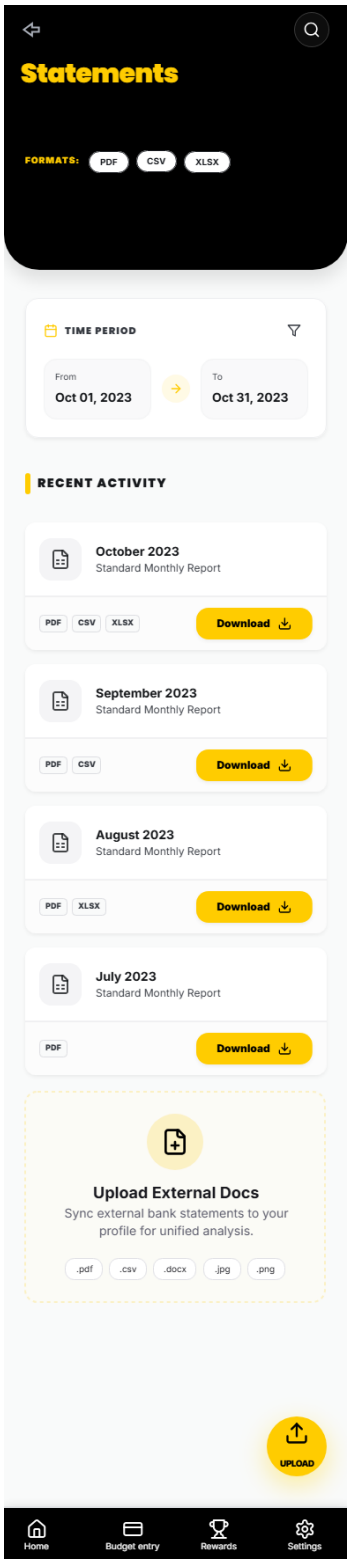

BudgetBee
LOGGED IN AS
Alex Johnson
WELCOME !
Search Transactions
Download Statement
Expense Entry
Progress Dashboard
Category Amounts
Current Balance
123 456,00
HOME
STATS

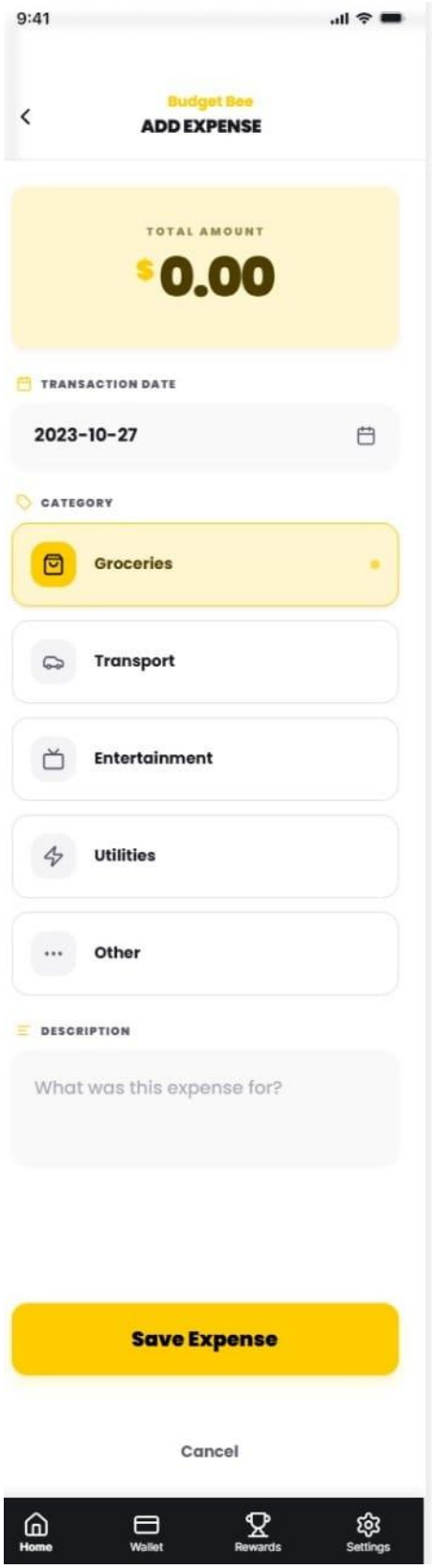
Home page



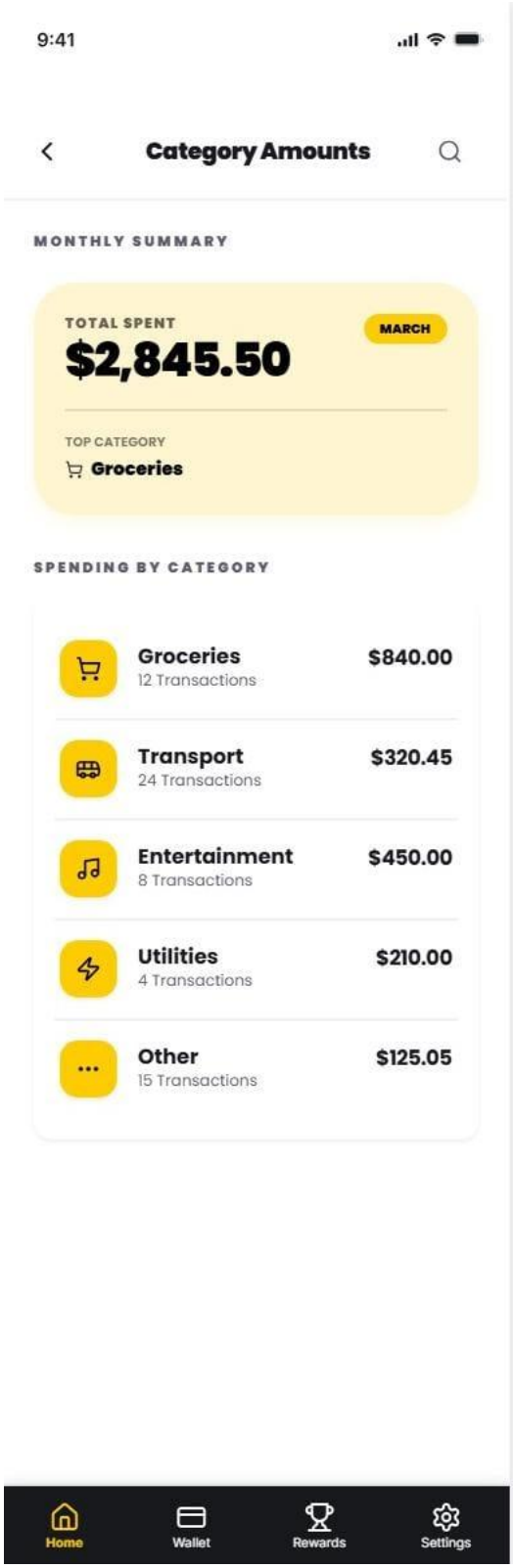
Budget entry tab

Statement tab:

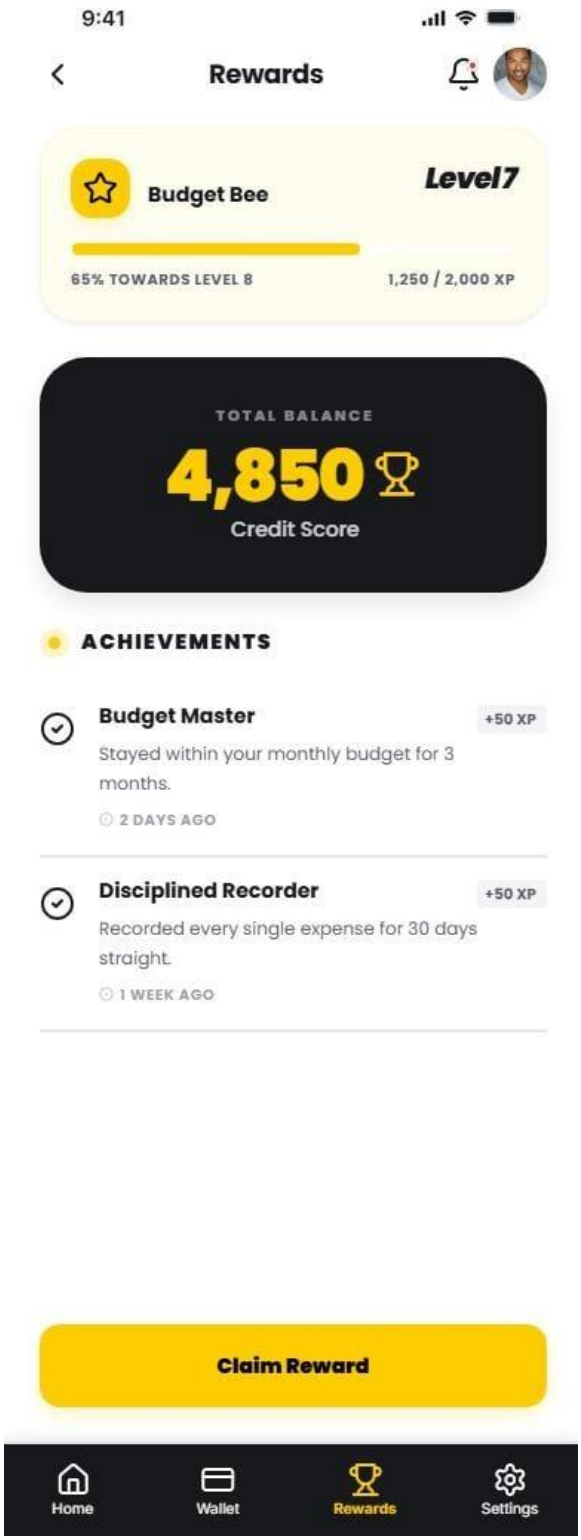




Expense entry tab

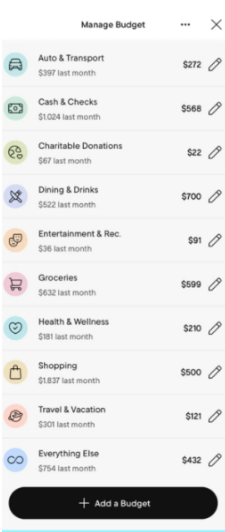


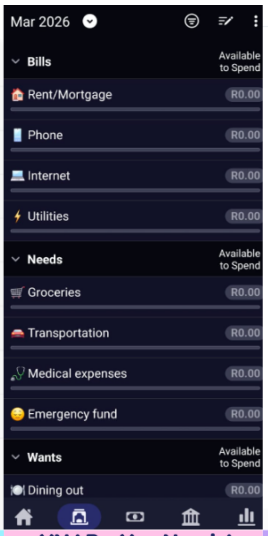
Category Amount Tab

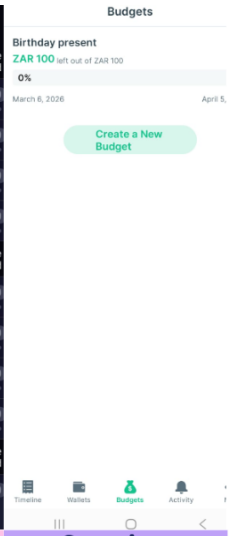

9:41
Rewards
Budget Bee
Level7
65% TOWARDS LEVEL 8
1,250 / 2,000 XP
TOTAL BALANCE
4,850
Credit Score
ACHIEVEMENTS
Budget Master
+50 XP
Stayed within your monthly budget for 3 months.
2 DAYS AGO
Disciplined Recorder
+50 XP
Recorded every single expense for 30 days straight.
1 WEEK AGO
Claim Reward
Home
Wallet
Rewards
Settings

Rewards Tab

Infographic of the 3 apps:







Rocket Money	YNAB - You Need A Budget	Spendee
adding a budget entry		
don't have to pay any fees, the free version is available	have to pay a fee in order to add a budget	need to choose a payment plan in order to add a budget
categorizing budget entries		
Automatically categorises transactions added, example groceries, and allows for custom categorization	can create budget categories and also group categories under broader headings	Categories can be customized by user
visual representation of expenses		
A bar graph is used to show users which category they spent the most money on	A pie chart is used to show how money is disturbed across different categories	Monthly Cash flow is represented with a bar graph
	Banks	
Connects to many banks through Plaid, which allows for a broader bank integration	YNAB connects to many banks, but not all banks worldwide	Is not able to sync to all banks, only certain ones
	Shared Finances	
Designed for individual financial tracking	Allows for shared budgeting between family or other users	Has a 'Shared Wallet' feature which allows more than one person access to a wallet so that multiple people can manage the expenses there.

Reference List

Adam, J. and Adam, J., 2018. *You Need a Budget (YNAB) App Review*. [online] finder.com. Available at: https://www.finder.com/budgeting/ynab-review?utm_source=chatgpt.com. [Accessed 10 March 2026].

Conger, C. 2026. *Track all your spending in one place. Rocket Money connects your accounts, categorizes transactions automatically, spots forgotten subscriptions, and shows exactly what's safe to spend*. [online]. Available at: https://www.rocketmoney.com/learn/personal-finance/tracking-expenses-with-rocket-money/. [Accessed 4 March 2026].

Connors, T. 2025. *Rocket Money Review: Budgeting, Subscriptions and Savings in One App*. [online]. Available at: https://www.thepennyhoarder.com/budgeting/rocket-money-review/. [Accessed 3 March 2026].

Equifax .2024. *Budgeting Apps: What Are They & How They Work | Equifax*. [online]. Available at: https://www.equifax.com/personal/education/personal-finance/articles/-/learn/budgeting-apps/. [Accessed 4 March 2026].

Hamilton, K. 2022. *Rocket Money is an app you can use to save money and better manage your financial life. Learn more about what Rocket Money is and why you should sign up.* [online] Available at: https://www.rocketmoney.com/learn/personal-finance/what-is-rocket-money. [Accessed 3 March 2026].

Kalinin, K. 2024. *Create a Personal Finance App for Budget Planning in 2024*. [online]. Available at: https://topflightapps.com/ideas/how-to-build-a-budget-app-for-personal-finances/. [Accessed 7 March 2026].

Luthi, B., 2022. *You Need a Budget App Review: Manage Your Money on a Zero-Based Budget*. [online] Experian.com. Available at: https://www.experian.com/blogs/ask-experian/you-need-a-budget-app-review/. [Accessed 10 March 2026].

May, D., 2026. *My Experience Using You Need a Budget (YNAB) | Money Guy*. [online] moneyguy.com. Available at: https://moneyguy.com/article/my-experience-using-you-need-a-budget-ynab / . [Accessed 10 March 2026].

Muzyka, R. 2024. *Building a Budgeting App: Opportunities, Challenges, and Tips*. [online] Available at: https://leobit.com/blog/how-to-build-a-budgeting-app-opportunities-challenges-and-practical-tips/. [Accessed 7 March 2026].

NextGen Money Skills. 2024. *How Does Rocket Money Work – A Comprehensive Guide for 2024*. [online] Available at: https://nextgenmoneyskills.com/how-does-rocket-money-work/. [Accessed 3 March 2026].

Paige, S., 2024.The Pros and Cons Of Budgeting Apps: Are They really worth it?. *Clever Dude*, [blog] 1 March. Available at: The Pros and Cons of Budgeting Apps: Are They Really Worth It? - Clever Dude Personal Finance & Money [Accessed 09 March 2026].

Sabatier, G., 2024.Spendee Review 2026. *MILLENIALMONEY*, [blog] 1 March. Available at: https://millennialmoney.com/spendee-review/#h-pros-and-cons-of-spendee [Accessed 05 March 2026].

Spendee, 2026. *Who is Spendee for?*. [online] Available at: https://help.spendee.com/article/115-who-is-spendee-for [Accessed 05 March 2026].

TrustPilot, 2026. *Spendee Reviews*. [online] Available at: https://www.trustpilot.com/review/spendee.com [Accessed 05 March 2026].